

Project Charter Template

Document Information

Field	Value
Document Title	[Project Name] Data Governance Implementation Charter
Version	1.0
Effective Date	[Insert Date]
Review Date	[Insert Date - Recommend Quarterly]
Owner	[Project Manager / Data Governance Lead]
Approved By	[Executive Sponsor / Data Governance Council]
Classification	Internal Use

Executive Summary

This Project Charter authorizes the implementation of [Project Name], a data governance initiative sponsored by [Organization Name]. It defines the project's objectives, scope, resourcing, governance structure, and success criteria, and grants the project team formal authority to proceed with planning and execution.

1. Project Purpose and Justification

1.1 Business Case

[Organization Name] requires this project to:

- Address identified data quality, compliance, or accessibility gaps documented in the Current State Assessment
- Translate the Data Governance Charter and supporting policies into operational capability
- Reduce risk exposure from regulatory, security, or data quality incidents
- Enable measurable business value through improved data trust and usability

1.2 Linkage to Strategy

This project directly supports:

- The enterprise Data Governance Charter and Governance Council mandate
- [Organization strategic objective, e.g., digital transformation, regulatory readiness]
- Findings from the Data Governance Maturity Assessment (target maturity: [Level])

2. Project Objectives

2.1 Primary Objectives

- Implement [specific governance capability, e.g., data catalog, stewardship model, quality monitoring] by [target date]
- Achieve [specific measurable outcome, e.g., 90% critical data element coverage] within [timeframe]
- Establish sustainable operating procedures for ongoing governance

2.2 Success Criteria

Objective	Success Metric	Target	Measurement Method
[Objective 1]	[Metric]	[Target value]	[How measured]
[Objective 2]	[Metric]	[Target value]	[How measured]
[Objective 3]	[Metric]	[Target value]	[How measured]

3. Scope

3.1 In Scope

- [Business units, domains, or data types included]
- [Systems and platforms included]
- [Specific deliverables, e.g., policy rollout, tooling configuration, training]

3.2 Out of Scope

- [Explicitly excluded business units, systems, or activities]
- [Items deferred to future phases]

3.3 Assumptions and Constraints

Assumptions:

- Required executive sponsorship and funding will remain in place for the project duration
- Business and technical stakeholders will be available as planned

Constraints:

- Budget ceiling: [Insert amount]
- Timeline: [Insert duration]
- Resource availability: [Insert constraints]

4. Project Governance and Organization

4.1 Project Sponsor

Name/Title: [Executive Sponsor]

Authority: Approves budget, resolves escalations, removes organizational barriers

4.2 Project Steering Committee

Role	Name/Title	Responsibility
Executive Sponsor	[Name]	Strategic oversight and funding
Chief Data Officer	[Name]	Governance alignment
Project Manager	[Name]	Day-to-day delivery
Business Lead(s)	[Name]	Business requirements and adoption
IT/Technical Lead	[Name]	Technical feasibility and delivery

4.3 Project Team Structure

- **Project Manager:** Overall delivery accountability
- **Data Governance Analysts:** Policy and process design
- **Technical Implementation Team:** Tooling, integration, and automation
- **Change Management Lead:** Communication, training, adoption
- **Business Data Stewards:** Domain requirements and validation

5. Milestones and Timeline

Phase	Milestone	Target Date	Owner
Phase 1: Initiation	Charter approved; team mobilized	[Date]	[Owner]
Phase 2: Design	Governance processes and standards defined	[Date]	[Owner]
Phase 3: Build	Tooling configured; pilot domain onboarded	[Date]	[Owner]
Phase 4: Rollout	Organization-wide deployment	[Date]	[Owner]
Phase 5: Stabilization	Handover to operations; lessons learned review	[Date]	[Owner]

6. Budget and Resources

6.1 Budget Summary

Category	Estimated Cost	Notes
Personnel	[Amount]	Internal and contracted

Category	Estimated Cost	Notes
		resources
Technology/Tooling	[Amount]	Licensing, infrastructure
Training and Change Management	[Amount]	Materials, sessions, communications
Contingency	[Amount]	Recommend 10-15% of total budget
Total	[Amount]	

6.2 Resource Requirements

- [Number] FTE Project Manager
- [Number] FTE Data Governance Analysts
- [Number] FTE Technical/Integration resources
- Business Data Steward time commitment: [Hours/week per domain]

7. Risks and Dependencies

7.1 Key Risks

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation Strategy	Owner
Stakeholder resistance to new processes	Medium	High	Early engagement, change management plan	[Owner]
Resource availability constraints	Medium	Medium	Secure commitments in charter approval	[Owner]
Technical integration delays	Medium	High	Phased rollout, technical spikes	[Owner]
Data quality issues surfaced during implementation	High	Medium	Dedicated remediation workstream	[Owner]

See the Risk Assessment Matrix for the complete risk register.

7.2 Dependencies

- Completion of Current State Assessment and Maturity Assessment
- Availability of governance tooling/platform licenses
- Approval of supporting policies (Stewardship, Quality, Classification, Privacy, Retention)

8. Communication Plan

Audience	Frequency	Channel	Owner
Steering Committee	Monthly	Status report and meeting	Project Manager
Data Governance Council	Quarterly	Executive summary	CDO
Project Team	Weekly	Stand-up / status meeting	Project Manager
Broader Organization	Milestone-based	Newsletter, town hall	Change Management Lead

9. Approval

This Project Charter has been reviewed and approved by:

Executive Sponsor: _____ **Date:** _____

[Name, Title]

Chief Data Officer: _____ **Date:** _____

[Name, Title]

Project Manager: _____ **Date:** _____

[Name, Title]

Appendices

Appendix A: Related Documents

[Link to Data Governance Charter, Implementation Roadmap, Risk Assessment Matrix]

Appendix B: Stakeholder Register

[List of all stakeholders, roles, and interest/influence levels]

Appendix C: Glossary of Terms

[Define project- and governance-specific terminology]

Document Control:

- This is a template document requiring customization for specific organizational needs
- Sections in [brackets] require organization-specific information
- Review with Project Management Office (PMO) standards before formal use
- Regular updates required to maintain currency and effectiveness